Quinn L. Girasek

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EDUCATION

Current MS Student, Virginia Institute of Marine Science, William & Mary, Williamsburg, VA — Planning on bypassing to the PhD program after two years, started Aug 2023

BS, *magna cum laude* (GPA 3.8), Biology, Juniata College, Huntingdon, PA — May 2022

HONORS/AWARDS

NSF GRFP Honorable Mention — March 2023

W&M Provost Distinguished Tuition Fellowship — February 2023

VIMS Foundation Fellowship — February 2023

Distinction in the Program of Emphasis - Biology — May 2022
Thesis: *"Investigating the Mesopelagic Ecosystem Along the Southeastern United States"*

The Dr. Homer C. and Ethel F. Will Biology Scholarship — May 2021
Awarded to Juniata biology students who have shown "high academic achievement and excellent potential for further study," as judged by departmental faculty and chair

Omicron Delta Kappa — Inducted May 2021
National Leadership Honor Society

Ernest F. Hollings Undergraduate Scholarship — 2020 – 2022
NOAA Office of Education
• Partial scholarship in support of junior and senior years of study
• Paid summer internship at a NOAA facility after junior year

Calvert Ellis Scholarship *(Juniata College)* — 2018 – 2022

Juniata Community Scholarship *(In honor of Dr. Kay Dellinger)* — 2018 – 2022

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Behrens KA, **Girasek QL**, Sickler A, Hyde J, Buonaccorsi VP. 2021. Regions of genetic divergence in depth-separated Sebastes rockfish species pairs: Depth as a potential driver of speciation. *Mol Ecol*, *00*:1– 17.

Girasek QL, Schields B, Buonaccorsi VP, Matter JM. 2021. Phylogenetic identification of North American ratsnakes (*Pantherophis*) in central Pennsylvania, USA. *Herpetol Rev*, *52*:17–20.

Radford KD, Spencer HF, Zhang M, Berman RY, **Girasek QL**, Choi KH. 2020. Association between intravenous ketamine-induced stress hormone levels and long-term fear memory renewal in Sprague-Dawley rats. *Behav Brain Res*, *378*:112259.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Girasek QL, McDowell JR. Hungry fish: What are roundscale spearfish (*Tetrapturus georgii*) eating? American Fisheries Society, Tidewater Chapter. 37th Annual Meeting, 2024

Girasek QL, Copeland AM, Egan KE. Analyzing the Mesopelagic Ecosystem Along the Southeastern United States. Association for the Sciences of Limnology and Oceanography. Ocean Sciences Meeting, 2022 (Also presented at the Juniata College Liberal Arts Symposium, 2022, and Biology Senior Thesis Night, 2022)

Girasek QL, Copeland AM, Egan KE, Collins AG. Investigating Mesopelagic Organism Occurrence Along the Southeastern United States. American Geophysical Union. AGU Fall Meeting, New Orleans, 2021

Girasek QL, Schields B, Buonaccorsi VP, Matter JM. Phylogenetic Classification of North American Ratsnakes (*Pantherophis alleghaniensis/spiloides/obsoletus*) in Central Pennsylvania. Juniata College Liberal Arts Symposium, 2020

CONFERENCE POSTERS

Behrens KA, Buonaccorsi VP, **Girasek QL**. Regions of genetic divergence in depth-separated Sebastes species pairs: Depth as a potential driver of speciation. American Fisheries Society, Pennsylvania Chapter. Technical Meeting: Adapting to Change, 2021

Lu J, **Girasek QL**, Somarelli J, Schultz T. Pollution-driven Evolution of PAH Tolerance in Atlantic Killifish Populations. Duke University. Office of University Scholarships & Fellowships Virtual Poster Session, 2020

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

American Fisheries Society, American Geophysical Union, Black in Marine Science (BIMS ally membership)

CERTIFICATIONS AND COMPUTER SKILLS

• FAA Part 107 remote pilot certificate (drone operation)
• Adobe Creative Suite, ArcGIS, Blender (3D graphics software), CSS, DragonFrame, Echoview, HTML, JavaScript, Microsoft Office Suite, PrusaSlicer (3D printing software), Python, R, and Unix

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Virginia Institute of Marine Science — Glouceester Point, VA
Graduate Research Assistant — August 2023 – Present
• Advisor: Jan McDowell, PhD
• Billfish genetics research

Smithsonian Environmental Research Center (SERC) — Edgewater, MD
Fall Citizen Science Intern — October 2022 – December 2022
• Mentored by Alison Cawood, PhD, Anna Davis, PhD, and Rylee Wernoch
• Project 1: Developing videos for educators and co-host a workshop, focused on restoring resilience in urban estuaries by working with teachers and helping them develop lesson plans for middle and high school students
• Project 2: Involved in Chesapeake Bay conservation with community-driven environmental monitoring and environmental education with faith-based organizations and the Smithsonian (SERC, NMNH)
• Project 3: Created an informational video, utilizing a DSLR camera, drones, and Adobe Premiere Pro
• Project 4: Made postproduction edits for the summer intern's videos and sound, including rerecording audio and b-roll (https://www.youtube.com/@SmithsonianSERC/videos)
• Extra: Carried out field work with other laboratories at SERC, including trawling, crab analysis, and banding

OceanX — Ocean (Monaco → Netherlands)
OceanX Young Explorers Program, aboard the R/V OceanXplorer — September 2022
• Program incorporated science and media aspects, and resulted in work products for each of those categories
• Prepared and operated oceanographic tools (ROV, XBT), including annotating the ROV dive in live time
• Prepared a CTD rosette for launch
• Prepared, collected, and analyzed eDNA data from a CTD rosette and sediment core
• Presented research on eDNA and CTD data analysis to crew and program participants
• Created and screened a short film to everyone on the vessel (filmed using a RED camera): https://youtu.be/HyIIsoJjpZk

Juniata College — Huntingdon, PA
Biology Research Assistant in the laboratory of Vincent Buonaccorsi, PhD — August 2019 – May 2022
• Extracted DNA, ran and stained gels, conducted bioinformatics and data analyses
• Co-authored scientific presentations, as well as manuscripts that were published in peer-reviewed journals

Juniata College — Huntingdon, PA
Biology Teaching Assistant for General Biology 2 — Fall 2021, Spring 2022

National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) Silver Spring, MD (remote)
Hollings Intern in NOAA Ocean Exploration June 2021 – August 2021
• Mentored by Adrienne Copeland, PhD and Katharine Egan
• Utilized acoustic, environmental (CTD), remotely operated vehicle (ROV), and satellite data to investigate how organism occurrence changes along the Gulf Stream and Deep Scattering Layer along the southeastern US
• Participated as a scientist from shore during expeditions EX2103 and EX2104, by annotating organisms observed during livestreamed transects
• Wrote two feature articles on those expeditions for NOAA Ocean Exploration's website
• Presented research at the NOAA Ocean Exploration Internship Symposium 2021 and AGU Fall Meeting 2021

Duke University Marine Lab Beaufort, NC (remote)
NSF REU Intern in the laboratory of Thomas Schultz, PhD June 2020 – August 2020
• Genotyped the ARNT gene to investigate how Atlantic Killifish (*Fundulus heteroclitus*) are able to tolerate poor water quality
• Presented research to REU participants and faculty at the end of the program
• Co-authored poster for the Duke 2020 Virtual Poster Session

Uniformed Services University of the Health Sciences Bethesda, MD
Summer Intern in the laboratory of Kwang Choi, PhD July 2019 – August 2019
• Ran assays and behavioral conditioning experiments with Sprague-Dawley rats to investigate the association between intravenous ketamine-induced stress hormone levels and long-term fear memory renewal
• Performed catheter surgery on Sprague-Dawley rats, also collected needle and trunk blood
• Co-authored a manuscript that was subsequently published in a peer-reviewed journal

OTHER EXPERIENCES

Graduate Council Williamsburg, VA
Vice President and Treasurer May 2024 – Present
• Helped plan events for all graduate students at W&M's five schools

Pet Sitter Williamsburg, VA
Animals: cats, dogs, reptiles October 2023 – Present
• Responsibilities included basic care and enrichment for the animal(s)

Heritage Humane Society Williamsburg, VA
Volunteer November 2023 – January 2024
• Completed 10.5 hours of formal training and a security background check
• Responsibilities include canine handling onsite and offsite

Graduate Council Williamsburg, VA
VIMS Representative September 2023 – May 2024
• Updated the other schools about events happening at VIMS

Sur La Table North Bethesda, MD
Kitchen Assistant March 2023 – August 2023
• Carrying out the mise en place for the different cooking classes that are offered
• Supporting students and chefs during the class
• Cleaning up after the class

Montgomery County Animal Services and Adoption Center Derwood, MD
Volunteer June – Aug 2022, Feb 2023 – August 2023
• Completed 12 hours of formal training and a security background check
• Responsibilities include canine enrichment activities and behavioral observations

Smithsonian National Museum of Natural History Washington, DC
Volunteer in Q?rius, an interactive space designed for teens June 2017 – December 2018
• Completed 40 hours of formal training and a security background check
• Communicated complex science topics with the general public, collected data on museum visitor interactions